DHL return label + reclamation form by email – one button (29.10.2026)

PDF version · Code files

> **Status 29.10.2026 – live in production.** One button on a return creates the DHL return label (if needed) and opens a prepared email to the customer with the label and the reclamation form, in German or English. Returns from a ticket are emailed from the ticket, so replies land in the ticket. Owner: Hamza. Users: Elena / Customer Care.

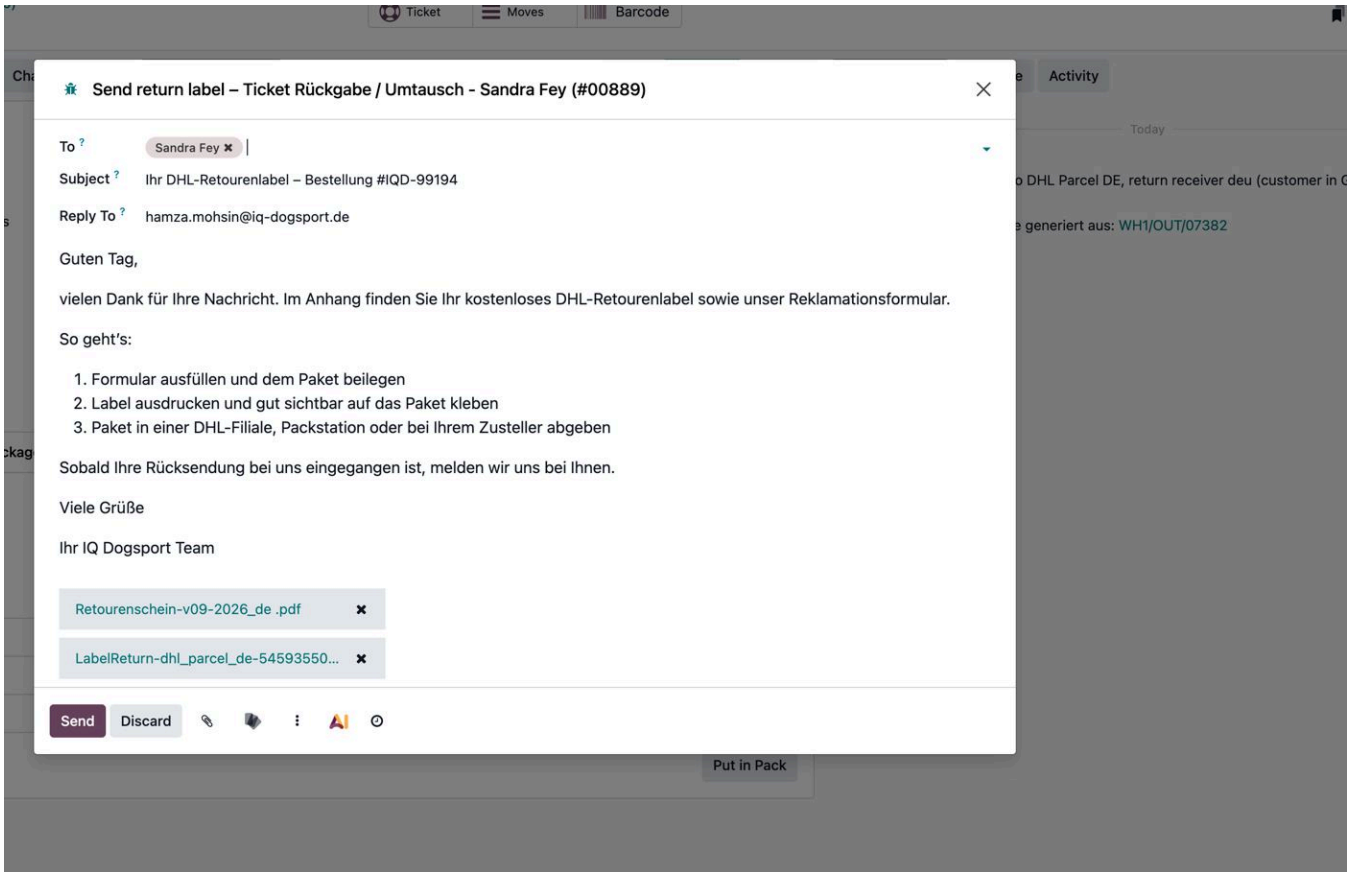
1. What it does

```
Return created (from ticket, sales order or delivery)
  └─ Automation: German customer + carrier empty → Carrier = DHL Parcel DE, Receiver = deu
Click "Retourenlabel senden"
  ├─ label already on the return?  → reuse it (no second DHL label)
  ├─ no label yet                  → create it via DHL (= "Print Return Label")
  │                                  DHL error → error shown, no email window
  ├─ customer language de_*        → template (DE) + Retourenschein DE
  │  otherwise                     → template (EN) + Retourenschein EN
  └─ email window opens (editable) with label + Retourenschein
       return belongs to a ticket → email posted in the TICKET (replies come back there)
       no ticket                  → email posted in the RETURN
Click "Senden" → email to the customer (from mail@iq-dogsport.de)
Label exists → button changes to "Retourenlabel erneut senden" (asks for confirmation, reuses label)
```

2. How staff use it

1. Create the return as usual (ticket → *Return*, sales order or delivery → *Return*).
2. Check: Carrier **DHL Parcel DE**, DHL Return Receiver **deu** (set automatically for customers in Germany).
3. Click **Retourenlabel senden**. Wait a few seconds (DHL).
4. Check the email (text, recipient, 2 PDFs), change the text if needed, click **Senden**.
5. If the window was closed without sending: click **Retourenlabel erneut senden** – the same label is used.

> Closing the email window does **not** delete the label – it was already created at DHL. Unused return labels are not charged (DHL bills only transported returns – confirm against the IQ Dogsport contract).



Production: email window from ticket #00889 with Retourenschein + DHL label

3. Components

#	Type	Name	Where
1	Automation rule	IQ – Return: DHL carrier for Germany	Settings › Technical › Automation Rules
2	Email templates	IQ – Return label for customer (DE) / (EN)	Settings › Technical › Email Templates
3	Server action	Send return label (production id **1777**, staging 1774)	Settings › Technical › Server Actions
4	Inherited view	IQ – Send return label button	Settings › Technical › User Interface › Views
–	Existing, unchanged	DHL – Automatic Return Receiver; DHL connector (BrowseInfo) method `print_return_label`	

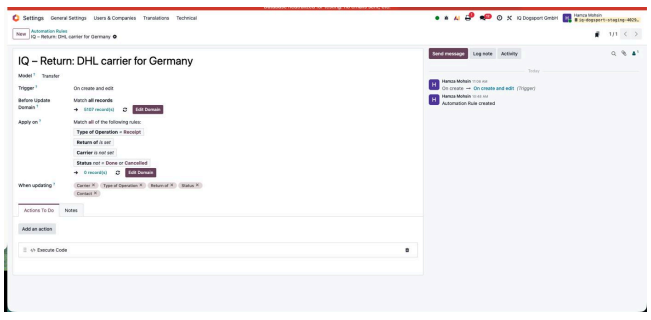
No new fields, no module, no schema change.

4. Automation: DHL carrier for Germany

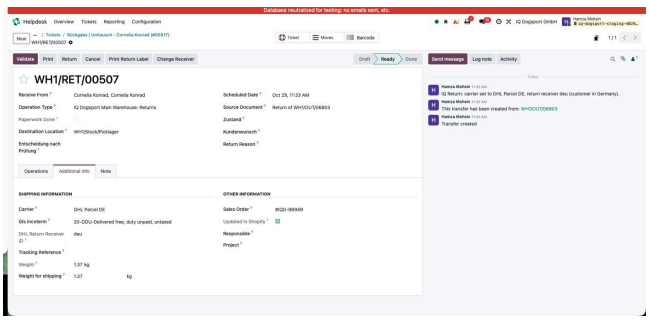
Odoo does not copy the carrier from the delivery to the return, and the sales-order carrier rules do not apply to returns. Without a carrier the DHL buttons are hidden.

```
 # Odoo 19 - Automation Rule (PRODUCTION since 29.10.2026)
# Name:          IQ - Return: DHL carrier for Germany
# Model:         Transfer (stock.picking)
# Trigger:       On create and edit
# Apply on:      [("picking_type_code", "=", "incoming"), ("return_id", "!=", False),
#                 ("carrier_id", "=", False), ("state", "not in", ["done", "cancel"])]
# When updating: Carrier, Contact, Type of Operation, Return of, Status
# Action:        Execute Code (below)
#
# Sets DHL Parcel DE + return receiver "deu" on open returns of German customers.
# "On create" alone did not work: Odoo fills "Return of"/state only after create.
# The receiver is set here as well because "DHL - Automatic Return Receiver" does not
# fire while the return is still being created.

carrier = env["delivery.carrier"].search([("name", "=", "DHL Parcel DE")], limit=1)
for picking in records:
    if picking.carrier_id or not carrier:
        continue
    partner = picking.partner_id
    country = partner.country_id or partner.commercial_partner_id.country_id
    if country.code != "DE":
        continue
    vals = {"carrier_id": carrier.id}
    if not picking.dhl_return_receiver_id:
        vals["dhl_return_receiver_id"] = "deu"
    picking.write(vals)
    picking.message_post(body="IQ Return: carrier set to %s, return receiver %s (customer
in Germany)." % (carrier.name, picking.dhl_return_receiver_id or "-"))
```



Rule: On create and edit, domain, When updating



Result: DHL Parcel DE + deu, chatter note

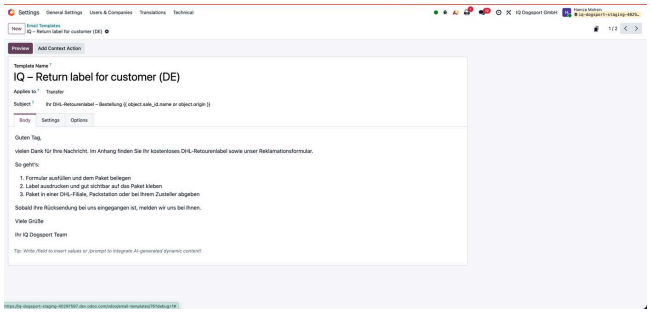
5. Email templates

EMAIL TEMPLATES (Settings > Technical > Email Templates) - names must contain "Return label for customer (DE)/(EN)"

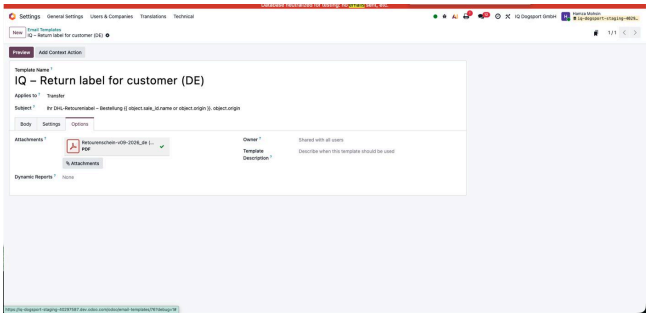
IQ – Return label for customer (DE)
  Applies to: Transfer
  Subject: Ihr DHL-Retourenlabel – Bestellung {{ object.sale_id.name or object.origin }}
  Language: {{ object.partner_id.lang }}
  Send From: empty (= mail@iq-dogsport.de, the only address allowed by the Office 365 mail server)
  Reply To: empty
  Attachment: Retourenschein (DE) PDF
  Body:
    Guten Tag,
    vielen Dank für Ihre Nachricht. Im Anhang finden Sie Ihr kostenloses DHL-Retourenlabel sowie unser Reklamationsformular.
    So geht's:
    1. Formular ausfüllen und dem Paket beilegen
    2. Label ausdrucken und gut sichtbar auf das Paket kleben
    3. Paket in einer DHL-Filiale, Packstation oder bei Ihrem Zusteller abgeben
    Sobald Ihre Rücksendung bei uns eingegangen ist, melden wir uns bei Ihnen.
    Viele Grüße
    Ihr IQ Dogsport Team

IQ – Return label for customer (EN)
  Subject: Your DHL return label – order {{ object.sale_id.name or object.origin }}
  Attachment: Retourenschein (EN) PDF
  Body:
    Hello,
    thank you for your message. Attached you will find your free DHL return label and our reclamation form.
    How it works:
    1. Fill in the form and put it in the parcel
    2. Print the label and stick it clearly on the parcel
    3. Drop the parcel off at a DHL shop, Packstation or with your DHL courier
    As soon as your return has arrived, we will get back to you.
    Kind regards
    Your IQ Dogsport team

Note: {{ }} placeholders only work in the Subject. In the body use /field (or no name, as now).



Template (DE) body



Template (DE) with Retourenschein attachment

6. Server action “Send return label”

```
 # Odoo 19 - Server Action (PRODUCTION id 1777, staging id 1774)
# Name:  Send return label
# Model: Transfer (stock.picking), Type: Execute Code, "Create Contextual Action" done
# Used by the buttons "Retourenlabel senden" / "Retourenlabel erneut senden" (view 3).
#
# 1. uses the existing LabelReturn PDF, or creates it via the DHL connector
(print_return_label)
# 2. picks template (DE) or (EN) by the customer's language
# 3. opens the email composer on the HELPDESK TICKET if the return belongs to one
#    (customer replies come back into the ticket), otherwise on the return
# 4. attaches the DHL label + the reclamation form (Retourenschein) from the template

picking = record

def find_label(p):
    return env["ir.attachment"].search([
        ("res_model", "=", "stock.picking"), ("res_id", "=", p.id),
        ("mimetype", "=", "application/pdf"), ("name", "ilike", "LabelReturn")], order="id
desc", limit=1)

label = find_label(picking)
if not label:
    if not picking.is_return_picking or picking.picking_type_code != "incoming" or
picking.state == "done":
        raise UserError("%s is not an open return - no return label can be created." %
picking.name)
    if not picking.carrier_id:
        raise UserError("No carrier on %s - please set DHL Parcel DE first." %
picking.name)
    picking.print_return_label()
    label = find_label(picking)
    if not label:
        raise UserError("The return label was created, but no 'LabelReturn' PDF was found
on %s. Please check the chatter." % picking.name)

lang = (picking.partner_id.lang or "").lower()
key = "(DE)" if lang.startswith("de") else "(EN)"
template = env["mail.template"].search([("model", "=", "stock.picking"), ("name", "ilike",
"Return label for customer " + key)], limit=1)
if not template:
    raise UserError("Email template 'IQ – Return label for customer %s' not found." % key)
tmp = env["mail.compose.message"].create({
```

```
    "model": "stock.picking", "res_ids": str([picking.id]),
    "composition_mode": "comment", "template_id": template.id})
subject, body = tmp.subject, tmp.body

ticket = env["helpdesk.ticket"]
# .sudo(): ir.model.fields is readable for administrators only (access error for Elena on
29.10.)
if env["ir.model.fields"].sudo().search_count([("model", "=", "helpdesk.ticket"), ("name",
"=", "picking_ids")]):
    ticket = env["helpdesk.ticket"].search([("picking_ids", "in", picking.ids)], order="id
desc", limit=1)
model, res_id = ("helpdesk.ticket", ticket.id) if ticket else ("stock.picking", picking.id)

composer = env["mail.compose.message"].create({
    "model": model, "res_ids": str([res_id]), "composition_mode": "comment",
    "subject": subject, "body": body,
    "partner_ids": [(6, 0, [picking.partner_id.id])]})
# template attachments are not copied when the composer is created from code -> copy them
form_ids = [att.copy({"res_model": "mail.compose.message", "res_id": composer.id}).id for
att in template.attachment_ids]
composer.write({"attachment_ids": [(4, label.id)] + [(4, i) for i in form_ids]})
# no tmp.unlink(): server actions may not delete mail.compose.message (access error); Odoo
cleans it up

action = {
    "type": "ir.actions.act_window",
    "name": "Send return label" + (" — Ticket %s" % ticket.display_name if ticket else ""),
    "res_model": "mail.compose.message", "res_id": composer.id,
    "view_mode": "form", "views": [[False, "form"]], "target": "new"}
```

Debug tooltip: Print Return Label = print_return_label (public method, callable from code)

7. Button view

```
<!--
Odoo 19 - inherited view (PRODUCTION)
View Name:              IQ – Send return label button
View Type:              Form
Model:                  Transfer (stock.picking)
Inherited View:         stock.picking.form  (External ID stock.view_picking_form, the one
WITHOUT parent)
View inheritance mode:  Extension View
Access Rights:          empty (all users)
name = id of the server action "Send return label" (production 1777 - NOT the staging id
1774)
-->
<xpath expr="//header" position="inside">
    <button name="1777" type="action" string="Retourenlabel senden" class="btn-primary"
            invisible="not is_return_picking or state == 'done' or picking_type_code !=
'incoming' or carrier_tracking_ref"/>
    <button name="1777" type="action" string="Retourenlabel erneut senden" class="btn-
secondary"
            confirm="Für diese Retoure wurde bereits ein Label erstellt. Erneut an den
Kunden senden?"
            invisible="not is_return_picking or state == 'done' or picking_type_code !=
'incoming' or not carrier_tracking_ref"/>
</xpath>
```

Inherited View: choose stock.view_picking_form (no parent)

Final view (production id 1777, German labels)

8. Tests

Test	Where	Result
German return gets DHL + deu automatically (RET/00507, 00508)	Staging	OK
Return outside Germany keeps empty carrier	Staging	to confirm
Button creates label + opens email with 2 PDFs (RET/00510)	Staging	OK
Return from order → email in return chatter (RET/00513)	Staging	OK
Return from ticket #00821 → email in ticket chatter	Staging	OK
Resend reuses label	Staging	OK
Ticket #00889 Sandra Fey (RET/00576), user Elena	Production	OK after `.sudo()` fix

Email window: Retourenschein + LabelReturn

Email logged in ticket #00821

Return without ticket: email logged on the return

After label: Resend button

9. Problems found & fixes

Problem	Cause	Fix
Carrier stayed empty with trigger “On create”	Odoo fills Return of / state after create	Trigger “On create and edit” + state filter
Receiver ID empty when carrier set by automation	“DHL – Automatic Return Receiver” does not fire during creation	Automation sets `dhl_return_receiver_id = deu` itself
DHL API Error 401 “no apiproduct match found” (staging)	DHL app without Returns API	Parcel DE Returns enabled in DHL developer portal
`{{ }}` printed literally in body	Placeholders only work in Subject	Greeting without name
Retourenschein missing in email	Template attachments not copied when composer is created by code	Copy `template.attachment_ids`
“not allowed to delete Email composition wizard”	`tmp.unlink()`	Line removed
Validation error “action_confirm is not a valid action on stock.picking.type”	Model of the view = Picking Type	Model Transfer, Extension View, parent stock.view_picking_form
Production button ran the VAT code	Staging id 1774 used (= VAT action in production)	Production id 1777
Elena: Zugriffsfehler ir.model.fields	Only admins may read ir.model.fields	`.sudo()` on that check
“no validated outbound DHL shipment (with tracking reference)”	Connector requires the original delivery shipped with DHL	See limits

Elena's access error before the .sudo() fix

DHL 401: Returns API missing on the app

10. Limits / open items

- **Only orders shipped with DHL:** the BrowseInfo connector refuses a return label when the original delivery has no DHL tracking (orders shipped with GLS / before 27.10). For those: create the label manually in the DHL business portal, or ask BrowseInfo to make the check optional.

- **Reply To** in the email window showed the sender's personal address (hamza.mohsin@...). Check where a customer reply lands; option: set Reply To to the ticket team alias (customer-care@ / b2b@).
- Germany only (receiver `deu`). deu vs deu_SZ decision with Florian still open – if it changes, update this automation *and* "DHL – Automatic Return Receiver".
- Carrier name "DHL Parcel DE" is hard-coded – do not rename the carrier.
- A German return cannot stay without carrier (the rule sets DHL again when emptied); choose another carrier instead.
- Price-only Shopify carriers (GLS Deutschland, DHL Paket, GLS EU) can still be validated without label – extension of "Block Validate without Carrier" proposed.
- Confirm with DHL that unused return labels are not charged.

11. Rollback

- Button: archive view "IQ – Send return label button".
- Automatic carrier: untick Active on "IQ – Return: DHL carrier for Germany".
- Templates / server action can stay; nothing else to undo. Labels already created stay on the returns.